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AT STANFORD UNIVERSITY CATHOLIC CHAPLAIN FIRED FOR B.P.P. SUPPORT WORK



MIRIAM CHERRY greets HUEY P. NEWTON, leader and chief theoretician of the Black Panther Party, at recent Book Party.

(Palo Alto, Calif.) - Lay minister Miriam Cherry, for five years associate Catholic chaplain for Stanford University, was fired from her position last week because she worked with Black Panther Party initiated survival programs in the Black, Chicano and poor communities of this otherwise affluent college town.

The action was taken by the governing body of St. Ann's Roman Catholic Church on March 10, at a highly charged four hour church council meeting attended by more than 200 parishioners and members of the Palo Alto community. Despite overwhelming support for minister Cherry repeatedly demonstrated by the large audience, the council voted 8 to 0, with two abstentions, to remove minister Cherry. The council consists of six Palo Alto residents, four Stanford students and one faculty wife.

Minister Cherry told THE BLACK PANTHER that although she had been aware of serious opposition to her ministry by certain powerful individuals in the Palo Alto White community, her immediate employer, campus Catholic minister Father John Duryea, had never approached her about her work. "My work was not being objected to by the chaplain, but by people not even connected with Stanford," minister Cherry is quoted as saying in *The Stanford Daily*.

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